

RITISH KOLAN

Principal Engineer | AI-Enabled Software & Web Platform Architect

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Principal/Lead Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience delivering enterprise web and cloud platforms, leading modernization initiatives, and translating business requirements into scalable production solutions.
- Combines deep React, TypeScript, web-platform, API, and AWS serverless experience with AI-assisted development using GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, Amazon Q, and OpenAI Codex to accelerate solution exploration, implementation, debugging, refactoring, and engineering productivity.
- Experienced in end-to-end solution delivery from discovery and technical design through rapid prototyping, implementation, deployment, production support, and continuous improvement, with strong stakeholder collaboration across Product, Business Analysis, and Engineering leadership.
- Technical leader with experience guiding distributed teams, mentoring engineers, leading proof-of-concepts, defining reusable architecture patterns, and balancing product outcomes with scalability, performance, maintainability, accessibility, and user experience.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI-Assisted Engineering	Solution Discovery & Delivery	Web Platform Architecture
Rapid Prototyping & POCs	Stakeholder Technical Leadership	React & TypeScript
Cloud-Native / Serverless	API & Integration Architecture	Platform Modernization
Developer Experience	CI/CD & DevOps	Engineering Leadership
Design Systems	Distributed Team Leadership	Production Support

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI-Assisted Development	GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, Amazon Q, OpenAI Codex
Frontend / Web	React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Angular, Storybook
Backend & APIs	Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, GraphQL, Serverless APIs; contributions to Java and C# integrations
Cloud / Platform	AWS, Lambda, API Gateway, CloudFront, S3, DynamoDB, Docker, Kubernetes
Design & Product Collaboration	Figma, Miro, Wireframing, Prototyping
DevOps / Productivity	CI/CD, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, JIRA
Testing & Data	Jest, Jasmine, JUnit, Postman, SOAP UI, Apidog; Oracle, MySQL, SQL Server

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Blackboard, Inc.	October 2021 - Present
Senior/Lead Technical Consultant	USA
- Serve as technical lead and architectural decision-maker for a cloud-native learning platform supporting a global LMS ecosystem serving 150M+ users across 80+ countries, guiding distributed engineering teams across the U.S., India, and South America. - Own end-to-end delivery of platform capabilities from requirements discovery and technical design through implementation, deployment, production support, and ongoing enhancement. - Partner with Product Managers, Business Analysts, and Engineering leadership to translate business needs into technical solutions, platform roadmaps, architecture decisions, and executable delivery plans. - Use AI-assisted development tools including GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, Amazon Q, and OpenAI Codex as part of day-to-day engineering workflows to accelerate implementation, troubleshooting, code refinement, and developer productivity while maintaining architectural and code-review oversight. - Evaluate emerging technologies, lead proof-of-concepts, and guide adoption decisions that influence platform architecture and future engineering direction.	

- Defined and executed modernization of business-critical applications from AngularJS to React, establishing reusable patterns, shared components, frontend standards, and scalable architecture across multiple products.
- Led migration from server-hosted infrastructure to AWS serverless architecture using Lambda, API Gateway, S3, and CloudFront, improving scalability and operational efficiency and reducing build times by approximately 45%.
- Designed reusable platform components, shared UI frameworks, service patterns, and extensible evaluation/automation frameworks that accelerated delivery across multiple product modules.
- Architected enterprise certificate-management capabilities spanning templates, awarding workflows, user administration, evaluation rules, notifications, and extensible platform services.
- Collaborate across frontend and backend services, contributing to Java, C#, AWS Lambda, and API integrations to deliver end-to-end platform capabilities.
- Provide architecture guidance, code reviews, mentoring, CI/CD improvements, production monitoring, incident resolution, and release governance to improve quality, reliability, and maintainability.

Browse Info Solutions

September 2017 - October 2021

Software Engineer

Michigan, USA

- Domino's Pizza - Senior UI Developer modernizing legacy systems into React-based SPAs, building reusable component libraries and scalable frontend patterns for high-volume customer-facing ordering experiences integrated with location services and real-time data workflows.
- OptimizeRx - Frontend Developer building responsive/isomorphic React applications with Redux, REST integrations, WebSockets, reusable UI patterns, dynamic forms, and responsive experiences across desktop, tablet, and mobile.
- Collaborated with UI/UX and backend teams to translate product and usability requirements into accessible interfaces, optimize API communication, and improve application performance and delivery quality.

Perficient Inc.

May 2016 - June 2017

UI Developer (Intern)

Detroit, MI

- Built responsive applications with React, Redux, Node.js, and MongoDB; integrated REST APIs, authentication with JWT/Passport, reusable components, Google Maps, GitHub APIs, and export capabilities.

Eastern Michigan University

May 2016 - April 2017

Graduate Assistant

Michigan

- Designed and developed accessibility-compliant student login systems and user-centered web experiences using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and jQuery; conducted usability testing and implemented UI improvements.

Indicode Technologies

May 2013 - July 2014

UI Developer

Hyderabad, India

- Built AngularJS/jQuery/Highcharts front-end applications, consumed REST services with Spring MVC backends, developed reusable components and routing, and performed cross-browser/accessibility validation.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Systems | Eastern Michigan University, Michigan | 2017 | GPA 3.6

Bachelor's Degree | Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, India | 2013